MIZORAM

Polling on **Nov. 7**

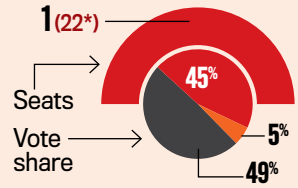
Counting on **Dec. 3**



Constituencies	Voters
40	**856,868**
First-time voters	**Polling stations**
50,611	**1,276**

2019 Lok Sabha

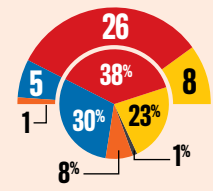
Total seats **1**



*Assembly segments won

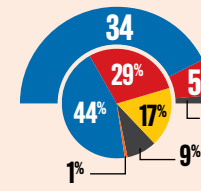
2018 Assembly

Total seats **40**



2013 Assembly

Total seats **40**



ST seats **39**



1 / 5 / 25 / 8 (in 2018 Assembly)

BJP Congress MNF ZPM Others



AN OLD HAND
Mizoram CM Zoramthanga

ANI

THREE-SIDED CONTEST

MNF HAS TO FIGHT OFF ZPM, OLD FOE CONGRESS

By **KAUSHIK DEKA**

Since its formation in 1987, the state of Mizoram has seen electoral fortunes swing between the Mizo National Front (MNF) and the Congress after every 10 years. Chief Minister Zoramthanga, whose party MNF grabbed power in 2018, must be hoping that this trend remains unbroken, but when 856,868 electors vote on November 7 to choose 40 MLAs, they will have one more significant choice—the Zoram People's Movement (ZPM).

The ZPM, born in 2017, not only emerged as Mizoram's second largest party in 2018, but created ripples in April 2023 by winning all 11 wards in the municipal polls in Lunglei town. The BJP is a fourth contender, though seen as a marginal player in a state with an 87 per cent Christian population.

Religious/ ethnic identities are crucial, and 79-year-old Zoramthanga is banking on the ethno-nationalism of the Mizo-Kuki-Chin-Zo ethnic groups, triggered by the military coup in Myanmar and the Meitei-Kuki conflict in neighbouring Manipur. Defying the Centre's directives, Zoramthanga has sheltered around 35,000 Chin refugees—of the same origin as Mizos—from Myanmar. This year, over 12,000 Kuki-Zomi people—of similar ethnicity—displaced from Manipur have been sheltered. Through this, the CM hopes to consolidate his position as a Mizo icon. The main poll planks of ZPM, led by 74-year-old Lalduhoma, are development and fighting corruption. Lalduhoma is popular with young urban voters. The Congress seeks to improve its performance by projecting a new leader, Lalsawta, a finance minister in its previous government. Known for his clean image, he is focusing on rural, farmers' issues.

Mizoram's otherwise enviably engaged civil society has one notable flaw. For a state where female voters outnumber males in 30 out of 40 constituencies, it's odd that only two women MLAs have been elected since 1987. There are six women among the 120 MNF, Congress and ZPM candidates. The BJP, which fielded six women out of its 15 candidates in 2018, has yet to announce its candidate list. ■

ASSEMBLY POLLS 2023
MIZORAM

THE CM'S REPORT CARD

STRENGTH

↘ **Sheltering Chin refugees from Myanmar, Kuki Zomis from Manipur can reap poll dividends**

CHALLENGE

↘ **There is a perception on the ground that Zoramthanga's government ignored development**